Architectural Orchestration for FASB ASU 2024-03 Compliance: A Comprehensive Playbook for BigQuery, Cortex Framework, and Agentic AI

The landscape of corporate financial reporting is undergoing a profound structural transformation with the finalization of the Financial Accounting Standards Board (FASB) Accounting Standards Update (ASU) 2024-03, formally titled "Disaggregation of Income Statement Expenses" (DISE).[1] This mandate represents the most significant change to expense reporting in several decades, fundamentally altering how public business entities (PBEs) must present their cost structures to the investment community.[3] Historically, United States Generally Accepted Accounting Principles (US GAAP) have permitted companies to report expenses by "function"—broad categories such as Cost of Goods Sold (COGS) or Selling, General, and Administrative (SG&A) expenses that describe the activity a cost supports rather than the nature of the resource consumed.[3] Under the DISE mandate, entities are now required to "disaggregate" these functional line items into their "natural" components, specifically highlighting labor, materials, depreciation, and amortization.[5]

The technical challenge of this transition is immense. Most modern Enterprise Resource Planning (ERP) systems, including mature installations of SAP and Oracle E-Business Suite (EBS), were designed to facilitate functional reporting and internal cost center management.[3] Once costs are captured at the source—such as a payroll run or an inventory purchase—they are frequently allocated, capitalized, or reclassified through complex layers of system logic. By the time these costs reach the income statement, the "natural" detail required by ASU 2024-03 is often lost or obscured within the functional buckets.[3] To meet the 2027 adoption deadline, organizations must re-engineer their data pipelines to maintain granular lineage from the transaction level to the final disclosure.[2] This report provides a comprehensive architectural playbook for leveraging the Google Cloud Platform (GCP) ecosystem—specifically BigQuery, the Cortex Framework, and Vertex AI Agents—to automate compliance, reduce manual effort, and extract strategic value from the transition.

The Regulatory Mandate: Navigating ASU 2024-03 (DISE)

The FASB's issuance of ASU 2024-03 was a direct response to a 2021 agenda consultation where investors overwhelmingly requested clearer insight into the expense structures of large corporations.[3] The objective is to provide decision-useful information that allows analysts and

investors to refine their predictive models for future income and cash flows.[5] By seeing the specific breakdown of labor versus materials, for instance, market participants can better understand a company's operating leverage and its sensitivity to specific economic pressures.[4]

Prescribed Natural Expense Categories

The mandate requires that every "relevant expense caption" on the face of the income statement be disaggregated into five mandatory natural categories in a tabular footnote.[5] A "relevant" caption is one that contains any of the following natural components:

Mandatory Natural Category	Scope and Accounting Considerations
Employee Compensation	Includes all forms of consideration given in exchange for service, encompassing salaries, benefits, and share-based payments.[4]
Inventory Purchases	Costs incurred to acquire inventory, excluding those recognized in business combinations or asset acquisitions.[5]
Depreciation	The systematic allocation of the cost of tangible assets over their useful lives.[5]
Intangible Amortization	The allocation of the cost of intangible assets, such as capitalized software or intellectual property.[5]
DD&A	Depreciation, depletion, and amortization specifically recognized as part of oil- and gas-producing activities.[5]

For many companies, the most challenging category is "Employee Compensation," which must be captured regardless of whether it is currently housed in the General Ledger (GL) or resides within separate payroll and HR systems.[3] Furthermore, the standard introduces a "reconciling item" approach for any residual amounts in a functional caption that are not covered by the five mandatory categories. This residual, often called "other items," must be qualitatively described if it represents a significant portion of the total.[3]

Compliance Timelines and Transition Strategies

The adoption timeline is structured to provide public business entities (PBEs) sufficient time to update their systems, although early adoption is permitted.[3]

Milestone	Application	Effective Date (Calendar Year Entities)
Annual Reporting	Full fiscal years beginning after Dec 15, 2026	December 31, 2027 [2]
Interim Reporting	Quarterly periods within fiscal years beginning after Dec 15, 2027	March 31, 2028 [2]
Adoption Method	Prospective or Retrospective	Choice made at the time of adoption [3]

The choice of transition method has profound data engineering implications. A prospective approach allows companies to build their comparative data sets over time, whereas a retrospective approach requires the re-indexing of historical data to ensure year-over-year comparability.[3] Given the complexities of legacy data, many organizations are expected to favor the prospective method to avoid the "archaeology" of untangling years of functional allocations.[3]

Architectural Foundation: The Unified Data Core

Meeting the DISE mandate requires an architectural shift away from reporting based on summarized balances toward a "look-through" approach based on atomic transaction data. The Google Cloud solution leverages three primary components that together form a "system of intelligence" for financial reporting.

Logic for the Google Cloud Cortex Framework

The Google Cloud Cortex Framework is the primary accelerator for this solution, providing the connectivity and semantic modeling needed to unlock data from complex ERP environments like SAP and Oracle EBS.[7] Its necessity arises from the extreme complexity of ERP schemas—for example, a standard SAP ECC installation can contain over 135,000 database tables.[9] Building custom extractors and mapping for this volume of data would take years, whereas Cortex provides pre-built "Value Accelerators" that can be deployed in weeks.[10]

The Cortex Framework is essential for DISE compliance because it provides the "Data Foundation" and hierarchy flattening tools needed to reconcile functional and natural

expenses.[12] In SAP, functional areas are often managed through Cost Center or Profit Center hierarchies. Cortex includes a solution to flatten these hierarchies, allowing the reporting layer to see exactly which natural transactions belong to which functional area, even when those hierarchies are deep and complex.[12] This ensures that the data used for the tabular footnote is identical in granularity and origin to the data used for the primary financial statements.[7]

Logic for BigQuery as the Scalable Ledger

BigQuery acts as the high-performance repository for the disaggregated data. Its role is twofold: it serves as the storage layer for Change Data Capture (CDC) records from the ERP and as the computational engine for the "High Cardinality Joins" required to map natural categories to functional captions.[7] Legacy on-premises databases often struggle with the query load required to analyze every line item of a COGS caption for a multi-billion dollar corporation; BigQuery's serverless architecture handles this scale effortlessly.[11]

Furthermore, BigQuery is required because the DISE mandate demands high levels of auditability.[3] The INFORMATION_SCHEMA and native audit logs in BigQuery allow an organization to demonstrate to auditors exactly how an estimate for "Inventory Purchases" was calculated, tracking the logic back to the source CDC tables.[15] The platform's ability to handle structured, semi-structured, and unstructured data also makes it the ideal environment for the AI agents to "ground" their analysis.[7]

Logic for Vertex AI Agents

While Cortex and BigQuery manage the data, Vertex AI Agents provide the cognitive automation required to interpret the DISE standard and apply it to the data.[18] The FASB DISE taxonomy is complex, and many legacy GL codes may not clearly map to the five mandatory natural categories.[20] AI agents, built with Gemini 2.5 Pro, possess a massive context window (up to 2 million tokens) that allows them to "read" the FASB taxonomy, internal accounting policies, and transactional data simultaneously to recommend accurate mappings.[21]

Agents are needed because traditional rules-based systems cannot handle the "qualitative" requirements of the standard, such as describing the "other items" bucket or determining whether a software cost meets the probable-to-complete threshold for capitalization.[6] By using a multi-agent orchestration pattern (A2A), specialized agents can collaborate: an Ingestion Agent extracts data from vendor invoices, an Analysis Agent maps it to natural categories, and an Auditor Agent reviews the results for compliance with the DISE mandate.[23]

The Implementation Playbook: A Phased Deployment Strategy

The deployment of this solution is structured into four distinct phases, aligning with the "Value

Accelerator" methodology provided by Google Cloud Consulting.[10]

Phase I: Foundation Setup and Data Ingestion

The initial phase focuses on establishing the "source-of-truth" datasets in BigQuery. The architecture must accommodate both real-time replication and batch loading to capture all relevant natural expenses.[11]

1. **ERP Connector Configuration**: For SAP, the BigQuery Connector (SLT Add-On) or Fivetran is used to replicate tables like ACDOCA (Universal Journal) and BSEG into BigQuery CDC datasets.[9] For Oracle EBS, Incorta is the recommended integration partner, handling the ingestion into BigQuery CDC datasets.[8]
2. **Dataset Establishment**: Separate BigQuery datasets must be created for "Raw" (source data), "CDC" (processed records), and "Reporting" (the semantic layer).[29] This segregation is critical for maintaining data integrity and complying with security policies like CJIS or FedRAMP.[29]
3. **Cortex Data Foundation Deployment**: Utilizing Cloud Build, the entity deploys the standard Cortex Reporting views. This provides a baseline of analytical artifacts, including Finance and Order-to-Cash data models, which serve as the starting point for disaggregation.[10]

Phase II: Semantic Modeling and Disaggregation Logic

Once the data is in BigQuery, it must be transformed to meet the specific requirements of ASU 2024-03. This phase involves "untangling" the functional allocations to reveal natural origins.[3]

1. **Hierarchy Flattening**: The entity executes the Cortex hierarchy flattener to map Cost Centers and Profit Centers to their functional parent captions (e.g., mapping "R&D Lab 4" to the "Research and Development" functional expense).[12]
2. **Natural Category Mapping**: A custom "Natural Mapping Table" is developed in BigQuery. This table uses SQL logic to tag GL accounts as "Employee Compensation," "Inventory Purchases," "Depreciation," "Amortization," or "DD&A".[5]
3. **Allocation "Look-Through"**: For costs allocated via internal assessments (e.g., Corporate IT allocated to Sales), the system must maintain the natural detail. This is achieved by joining the allocation journal entries with the original source transactions in the ACDOCA or EBS GL_BALANCES tables.[12]

Phase III: Agentic Automation and Narrative Generation

This phase introduces Vertex AI Agents to automate the mapping of ambiguous transactions and the drafting of the disclosure narratives.[19]

1. **Taxonomy Grounding**: The entity uses Vertex AI Search to index the FASB Taxonomy Implementation Guide.[18] This allows the agents to provide responses that are "grounded"

in the official regulatory guidance.

2. **ComplianceAuditor Agent Design**: Built using the Agent Development Kit (ADK), this agent is instructed to act as a "hostile auditor," identifying functional captions where disaggregation is incomplete or where the "other items" bucket is excessively large.[23]
3. **Structured Output Integration**: The agents are configured to return findings in structured JSON format, allowing the results to be pushed directly into a Looker dashboard or a disclosure management tool.[23]

Phase IV: Reconciliation and Final Reporting

The final phase ensures that the disaggregated data matches the primary financial statements, a prerequisite for audit approval.[3]

1. **Tabular Footnote Generation**: The reporting agent aggregates the mapped data into the mandated tabular format for each relevant expense caption.[6]
2. **Automated Reconciliation**: The system performs a "T-minus close" check, comparing the total of the disaggregated footnote to the functional line item on the income statement.[6] Any discrepancy triggers an alert to the accounting team.
3. **Audit Trail Export**: All logic, agentic prompts, and manual adjustments are logged in BigQuery, providing a comprehensive audit trail that meets SOX and SEC requirements.[33]

GCP Consumption Analysis: Modeling Expenditure for DISE Compliance

Estimating the cost of a DISE compliance solution requires an understanding of the interplay between data volume (storage), computational complexity (slots), and AI intelligence (tokens). The following estimates are based on a "Composite Organization" processing approximately 10 TB of active financial data with a multi-agent workflow.[35]

BigQuery Slot Utilization and Storage Economics

BigQuery offers two primary pricing models: on-demand (pay-per-query) and capacity-based (pay-per-slot).[37] For financial reporting, where workloads are predictable but spike during "close" periods, a capacity-based model is generally preferred for price predictability.[14]

Resource Component	Unit Price (USD)	Monthly Utilization (Estimate)	Estimated Monthly Cost
Active Logical	$0.02 / GiB [37]	10,000 GiB (10 TB)	$200

Storage			
Long-term Storage	$0.01 / GiB [37]	40,000 GiB (Historical)	$400
Baseline Slots (Commitment)	$1,700 / 100 slots [38]	300 Slots	$5,100
Autoscale Slots (Flex)	$0.04 / slot-hour [38]	2,000 slot-hours (Close spike)	$80
Total BigQuery Estimate	--	--	**$5,780**

The "Baseline Slots" ensure that critical daily reporting and CDC processing remain performant, while "Autoscale Slots" handle the heavy computational load of the month-end disaggregation and reconciliation.[14]

Vertex AI Agentic Consumption and Token Benchmarks

AI consumption is metered by the number of input and output tokens, with tiered pricing based on the model (Pro vs. Flash) and the context size.[22]

Service Layer	Unit Price (USD)	Estimated Monthly Volume	Estimated Monthly Cost
Gemini 2.5 Pro (Input)	$1.25 / 1M Tokens [22]	2,000M Tokens	$2,500
Gemini 2.5 Pro (Output)	$10.00 / 1M Tokens [22]	300M Tokens	$3,000
Context Caching Storage	$4.50 / 1M Tokens/hr [22]	50M Tokens (Taxonomy/Policies)	$225
Enterprise Search Queries	$4.00 / 1,000 queries [19]	50,000 Queries	$200

Total Vertex AI Estimate	--	--	**$5,925**

To optimize these costs, the architecture utilizes Gemini 2.5 Pro for complex reasoning (such as policy interpretation) and Gemini 2.5 Flash for high-throughput, low-latency tasks like document extraction.[21] The use of "Context Caching" is a critical cost-control mechanism, as it allows the entity to pay only 10% of the standard input cost for repeated tokens, such as the FASB taxonomy or the corporate chart of accounts.[42]

Summary of Average Monthly GCP Consumption

For a global enterprise, the total monthly GCP consumption for a production-grade DISE solution is estimated at approximately **$12,000 to $15,000**. This excludes initial implementation services but covers the full technological stack required to automate compliance and maintain a "liquid" financial data core.[10]

Cost Takeout Opportunities: Driving Strategic ROI

The implementation of a modern DISE solution on GCP provides significant opportunities for "cost takeout"—the elimination of inefficient legacy expenses that can fund the modernization effort.[43]

Decommissioning of Legacy Infrastructure

Many organizations maintain a "gridlock" of legacy SQL servers, on-premises data centers, and outdated ETL tools that are expensive to maintain and lack AI capabilities.[45]

- **Infrastructure Retirement**: By migrating financial data to BigQuery, a composite organization can retire approximately 780 servers, resulting in a three-year cost saving of $13.1 million.[35]
- **License Retirement**: Consolidating on a single GCP platform allows for the retirement of redundant third-party reporting and disclosure management tools, which can reduce operational expenses (OpEx) by 90% by the third year of decommissioning.[47]
- **Maintenance Reduction**: Legacy maintenance costs typically grow 10-15% annually.[44] Moving to a managed serverless environment like BigQuery eliminates these fixed capacity costs and reduces the need for specialized legacy technology staff, who command a 35-45% salary premium.[44]

Labor Efficiency and Productivity Lift

The DISE mandate traditionally requires a massive increase in manual accounting effort.[3] Agentic AI reverses this trend by automating the "drudge work" of financial reporting.[49]

- **Financial Reconciliation Savings**: Deploying intelligent AI agents for reconciliation and

mapping (REKON) can yield a 6.8x return on investment (ROI) over three years.[51]

- **Process Automation Rate**: AI agents achieve an 85% process automation rate compared to just 30% for traditional RPA, primarily because they can handle unstructured data like vendor invoices and policy memos.[51]
- **FTE Reallocation**: For a typical enterprise, AI-assisted data integration can save 1,300 analyst hours annually per process.[52] At an average cost of $87 per hour, a single automated workflow can generate $113,100 in annual productivity gains.[52]

Strategic and Regulatory ROI

While harder to quantify, the strategic benefits of this architecture are substantial. Improved data operations can shorten month-end processes from days to hours, enabling real-time utilization of financial data for strategic decision-making.[35]

ROI Dimension	Primary Driver	Impact Metric
Compliance Risk	Expert data management and AI-auditing	$2.8M in avoided fines over 3 years [35]
Operating Profit	Technology upgrades driving better forecasting	1.4M increase in operating profit [35]
Error Reduction	AI contextual understanding (99.7% accuracy)	30-60% reduction in reporting errors [50]
Feature Delivery	Modernized developer environment	40% increase in feature delivery speed [53]

Risk Management and Security Alignment

Financial data is the most sensitive asset of any corporation, and the DISE architecture must adhere to the highest security standards. The Google Cloud environment supports this through the "Shared Responsibility Model" and specialized compliance tools.[30]

Data Residency and Sovereignty

For global entities, the "Assured Workloads" feature in GCP allows for the enforcement of data residency, ensuring that sensitive financial data (such as CJI or payroll records) remains within specific geographic boundaries (e.g., US-only regions) to comply with local regulations.[30] This is critical for meeting the FASB's enhanced disclosure requirements without violating privacy

laws like GDPR.[30]

Governance and Access Control

The architecture leverages Cloud Identity and IAM to enforce a "Principle of Least Privilege".[30] Admin groups are federated with the company's existing identity provider (e.g., Active Directory), ensuring that only authorized personnel can access the disaggregated financial data or modify the AI agent's behavior.[19] Furthermore, the Cortex Cloud Application Security framework provides "shift-left" compliance, automatically mapping infrastructure-as-code (IaC) configurations to industry standards like CIS Benchmarks.[54]

Conclusion: The Strategic Path Forward

The FASB DISE mandate (ASU 2024-03) is more than a compliance hurdle; it is a catalyst for the modernization of the Office of the CFO. The traditional approach—manual spreadsheets and functional silos—is fundamentally incompatible with the level of granularity and speed required by the new standard.[3] The architectural playbook presented here—leveraging the Cortex Framework for connectivity, BigQuery for scale, and Vertex AI Agents for intelligence—provides a robust, audit-ready solution that meets the 2027 deadline while driving significant operational ROI.[7]

By proactively adopting this stack, organizations can transform their financial reporting from a retrospective "compliance exercise" into a proactive "strategic asset." The ability to disaggregate expenses in real-time allows leadership to identify cost-saving opportunities, optimize labor allocation, and provide investors with the transparency they demand.[4] As the 2027 adoption date approaches, the entities that have successfully built this unified data core and agentic workforce will be the ones that thrive in an increasingly data-driven market landscape.[2]

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